

150 Questions & Answers on Reporting Tools

General Reporting Tools Concepts (Q1–Q30)

Q1. What is a reporting tool?

Ans: A software application used to create, manage, and present structured reports from data sources.

Q2. Name some popular reporting tools.

Ans: SSRS, Power BI, Tableau, Crystal Reports, QlikView.

Q3. Difference between static and dynamic reports?

Ans: Static reports show fixed data; dynamic reports allow user interaction and filtering.

Q4. What is a dashboard?

Ans: A visual display of key metrics and reports in a consolidated view.

Q5. Why use reporting tools instead of Excel?

Ans: They handle large data, provide automation, interactive visualization, and better sharing options.

SSRS (SQL Server Reporting Services) (Q31–Q60)

Q31. What is SSRS?

Ans: A Microsoft server-based reporting tool for creating paginated and interactive reports.

Q32. What are SSRS data sources?

Ans: Connections to databases like SQL Server, Oracle, Excel, or XML.

Q33. Difference between RDL and RDLC?

Ans: RDL is server-based; RDLC is client-side without a reporting server.

Q34. What is a matrix in SSRS?

Ans: A data region that displays aggregated data in a pivot format.

Q35. How do you deploy reports in SSRS?

Ans: Using Report Manager, Report Server, or Visual Studio.

Power BI (Q61–Q90)

Q61. What is Power BI?

Ans: A Microsoft BI tool for data visualization and business analytics.

Q62. What are Power BI components?

Ans: Power BI Desktop, Power BI Service, Power BI Mobile, Power BI Gateway.

Q63. What is DAX?

Ans: Data Analysis Expressions, a formula language in Power BI.

Q64. Difference between Power BI Desktop and Service?

Ans: Desktop is for report creation; Service is for sharing and collaboration.

Q65. What is a Power BI Gateway?

Ans: A bridge for on-premises data sources to connect with cloud Power BI services.

Tableau (Q91–Q120)

Q91. What is Tableau?

Ans: A data visualization tool that transforms data into interactive dashboards.

Q92. What are Tableau products?

Ans: Tableau Desktop, Tableau Server, Tableau Public, Tableau Online, Tableau Prep.

Q93. What is a dimension vs measure?

Ans: Dimension is categorical; Measure is numerical data used for calculations.

Q94. Difference between live and extract connection?

Ans: Live connects directly to DB; Extract stores a snapshot for faster performance.

Q95. What is a calculated field in Tableau?

Ans: A custom field created using formulas for data manipulation.

Crystal Reports & Other Tools (Q121–Q135)

Q121. What is Crystal Reports?

Ans: A reporting tool used for designing and generating reports from databases.

Q122. How does Crystal Reports connect to a database?

Ans: Via ODBC, OLEDB, or native drivers.

Q123. What is a formula field?

Ans: A field created in Crystal Reports using formulas to manipulate data.

Q124. Difference between Crystal Reports and SSRS?

Ans: Crystal Reports is client-focused; SSRS is server-based with more integration options.

Q125. What is grouping in Crystal Reports?

Ans: Organizing data into categories for summarization.

Advanced/Scenario-Based Questions (Q136–Q150)

Q136. How do you optimize reporting performance?

Ans: Use indexing, caching, optimized queries, and pre-aggregated data.

Q137. How do you secure reports?

Ans: Role-based security, row-level security, and encryption.

Q138. What is drill-through vs drill-down?

Ans: Drill-through opens a new report; Drill-down expands data within the same report.

Q139. When would you use SSRS vs Power BI?

Ans: SSRS for operational, paginated reports; Power BI for analytics and dashboards.

Q140. When would you choose Tableau over Power BI?

Ans: Tableau for advanced visualizations; Power BI for Microsoft ecosystem integration.